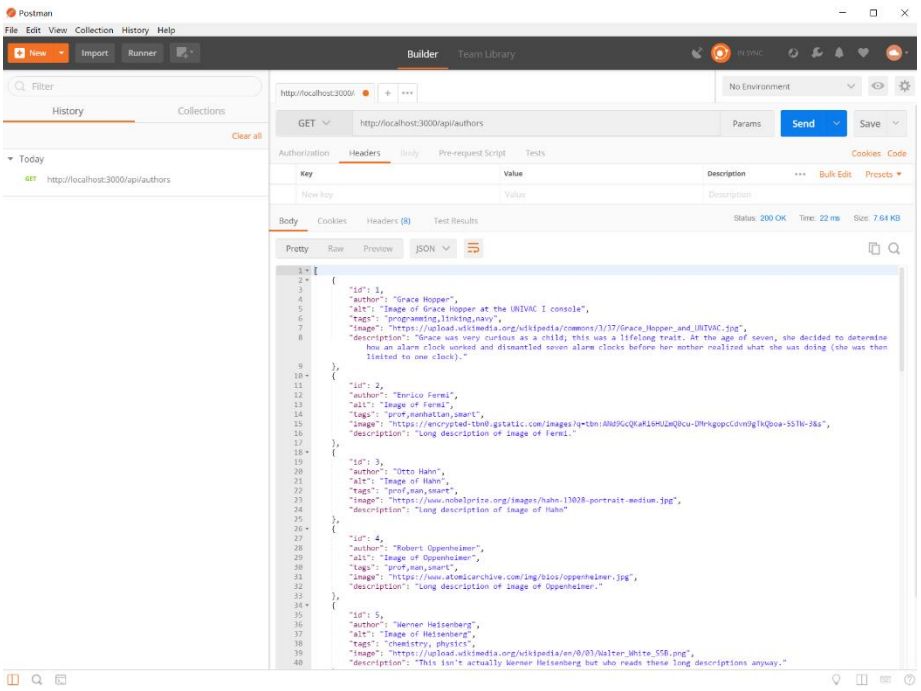
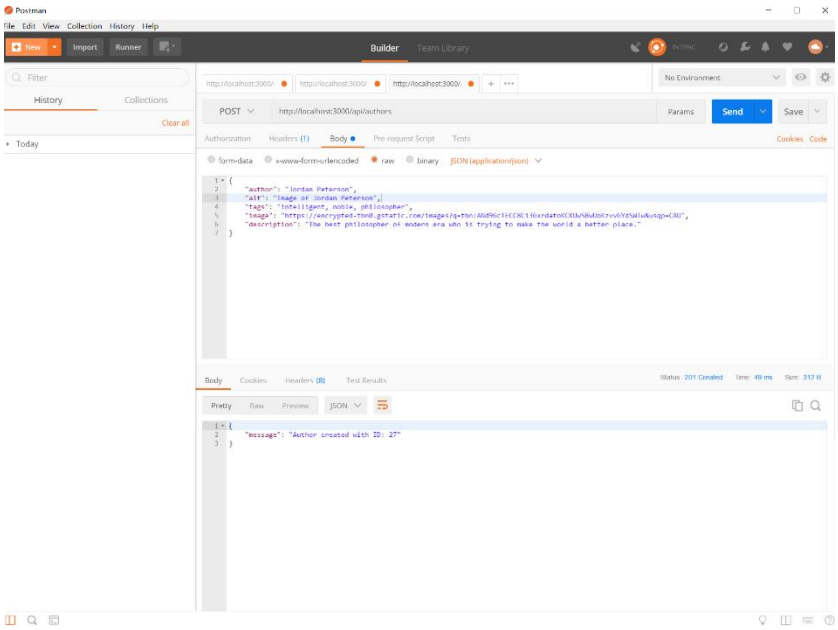
1. retrieving the full dataset



Using the GET method to request the endpoint successfully retrieves the full dataset (all rows currently stored in the local photo database), returning a json array containing information about 13 photo objects. The response status code is: 200, MIME Type is: application/json. Documentation contains URL of this endpoint, request descriptions, return descriptions, possible return status codes and return data.

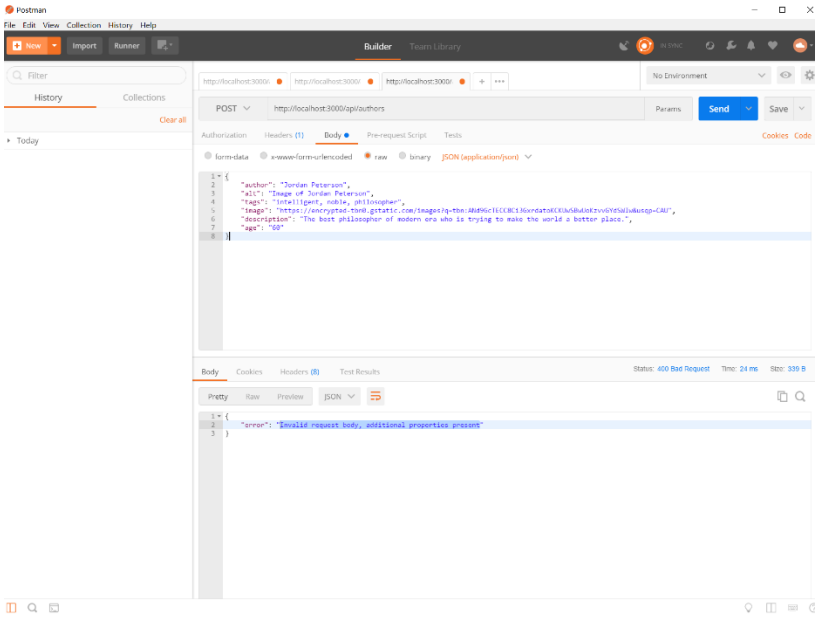
2. adding data (Create)



Using the POST method to request http://localhost:3000/api/authors, and publishing a json data containing photo information, returning a json format data, and the prompt message is: Author created with ID: 27.

The response status code is: 201, MIME Type is: application/json.

Documentation contains the URL, request description, and return description of this endpoint, but it is different from the actual return. The return message described in the documentation is: Author created.

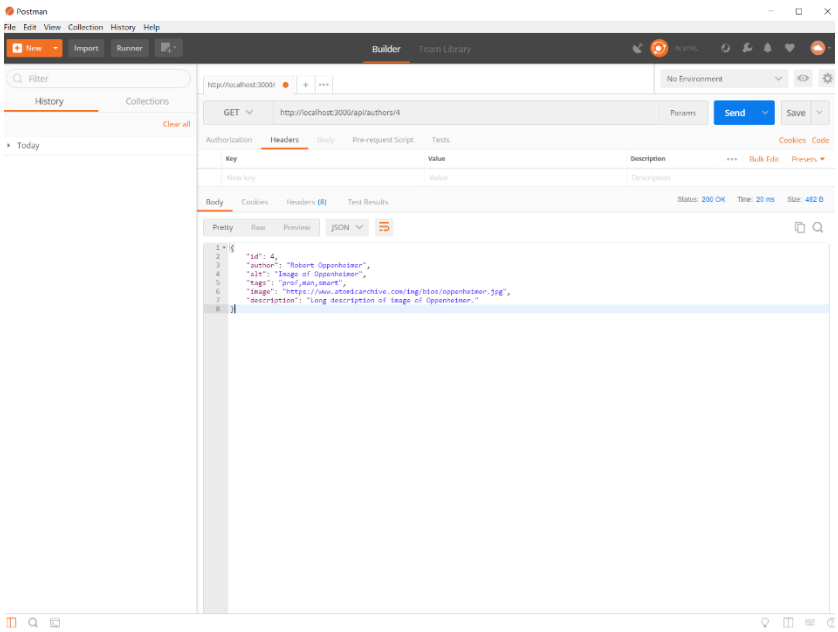


Using the POST method to request http://localhost:3000/api/authors. When the requested json data contains an additional parameter age, a 400 error code is returned, and the prompt message is: Invalid request body, additional properties present. If a photo parameter is missing in the requested json data, the status and error message returned by the API are the same.

The response status code is: 201, MIME Type is: application/json.

Documentation contains URL for this endpoint, request description, return description.

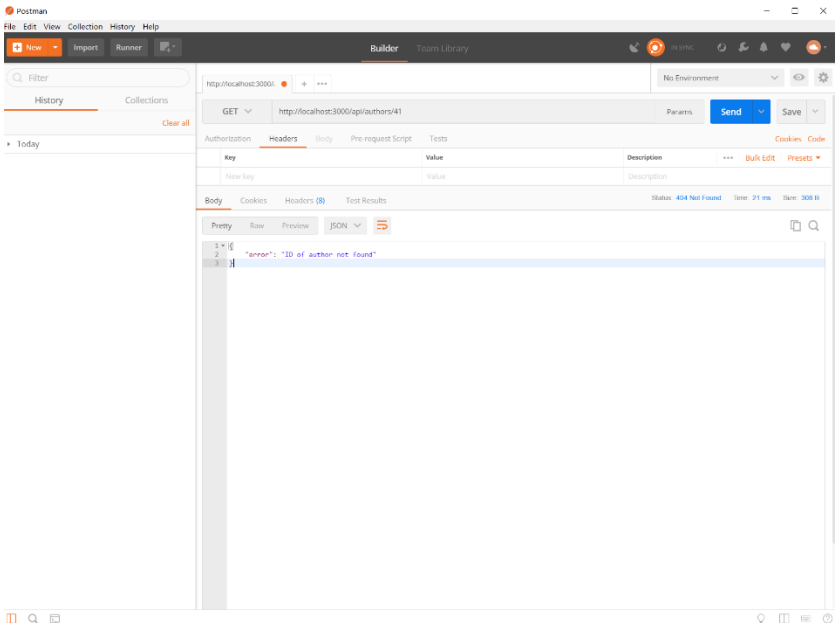
3. listing data for a specific item (Retrieve)



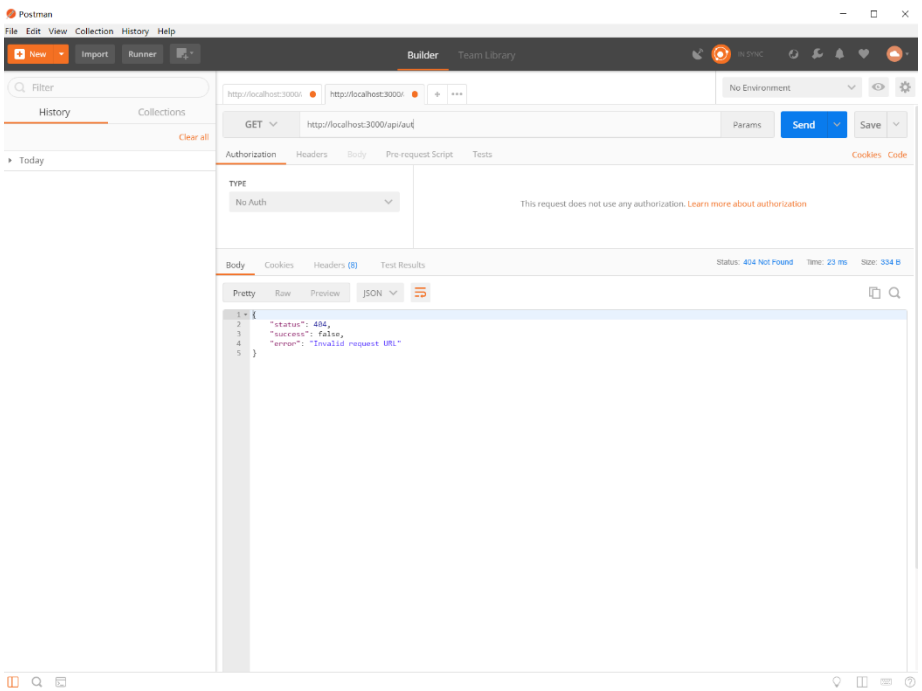
Using the GET method to request the endpoint list the data of a specific item successfully, and returning the photo detail of the specified id is 4.

The response status code is: 200, MIME Type is: application/json.

Documentation contains URL of this endpoint, request descriptions, return descriptions, possible return status codes and return data.



Using the GET method to request the detail of photo id 41 failed, and an error message in json format was returned: ID of author not found. The response status code is: 404, MIME Type is: application/json. Documentation contains URL of this endpoint, request descriptions, return descriptions, possible return status codes and return data.



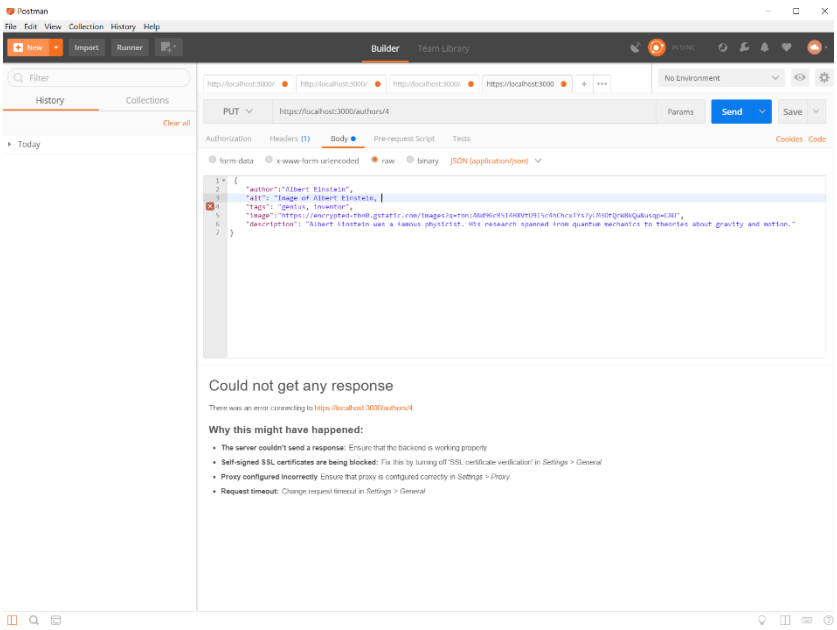
When using the GET method to request an incorrect URL:

http://localhost:3000/api/aut, an error message in json format is returned: Invalid request URL, and contains a status attribute with a value of 404 and a success attribute with a value of false.

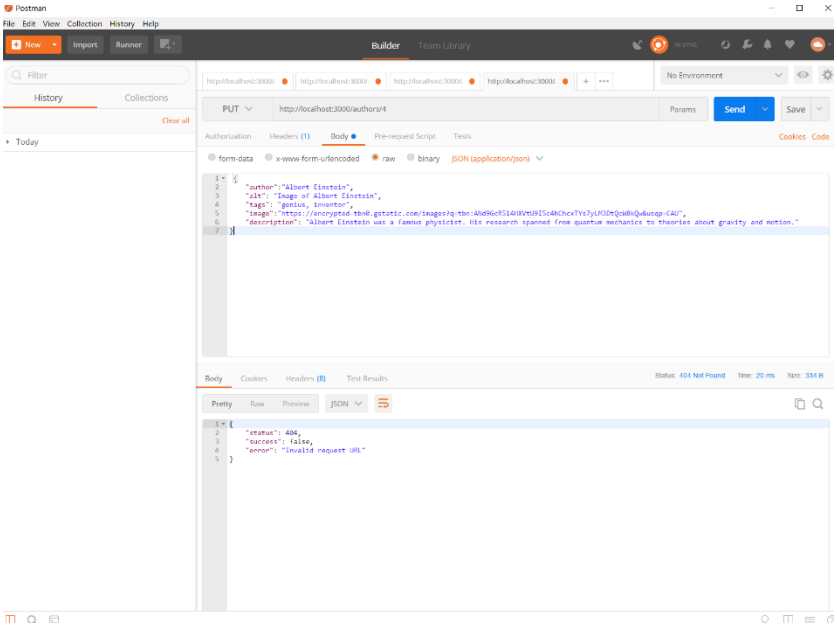
The response status code is: 404, MIME Type is: application/json.

Documentation contains URL of this endpoint, request descriptions, return descriptions, possible return status codes and return data.

4. changing data of a specific item (Update)



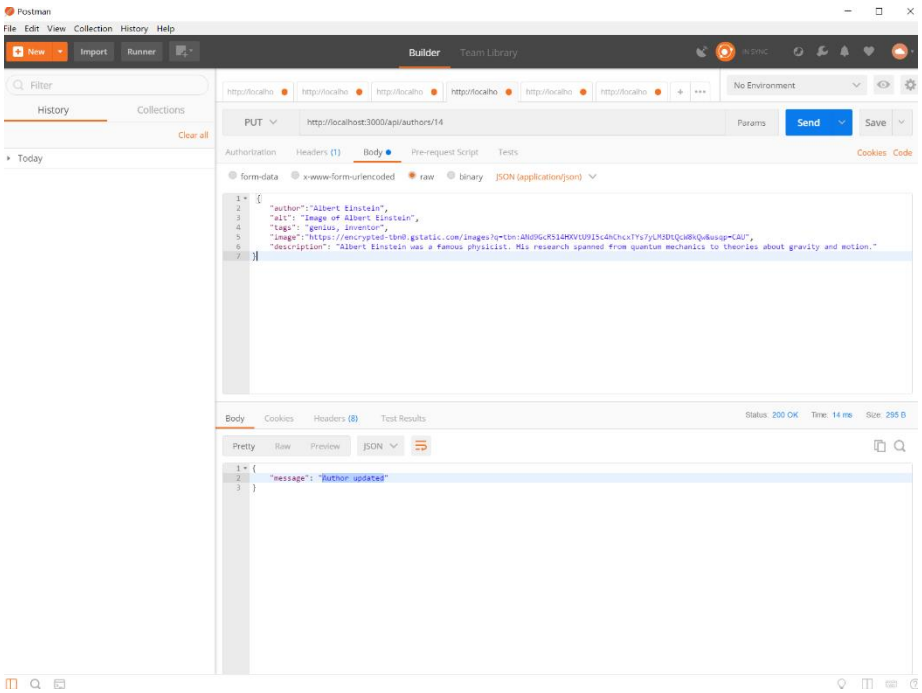
According to the steps suggested in the documentation, using the PUT method to request https://localhost:3000/authors/4, and posting a parameter information in json format. Postman prompts: Could not get any response, and the sample request data provided in the documentation is not a legal json format, the parameter value lacks a double quote.



Manually changing the requested https to http, and changing the json data of the post to the standard json format. After submitting the data, the API returns a 404 status code, and the error message: Invalid request URL. I queried the information with photo id 4 again, and found that the data was not modified successfully, which proves that this API interface cannot be called normally.

The response status code is: 404, MIME Type is: application/json.

Documentation contains URL of this endpoint, request descriptions, return descriptions, possible return status codes and return data.



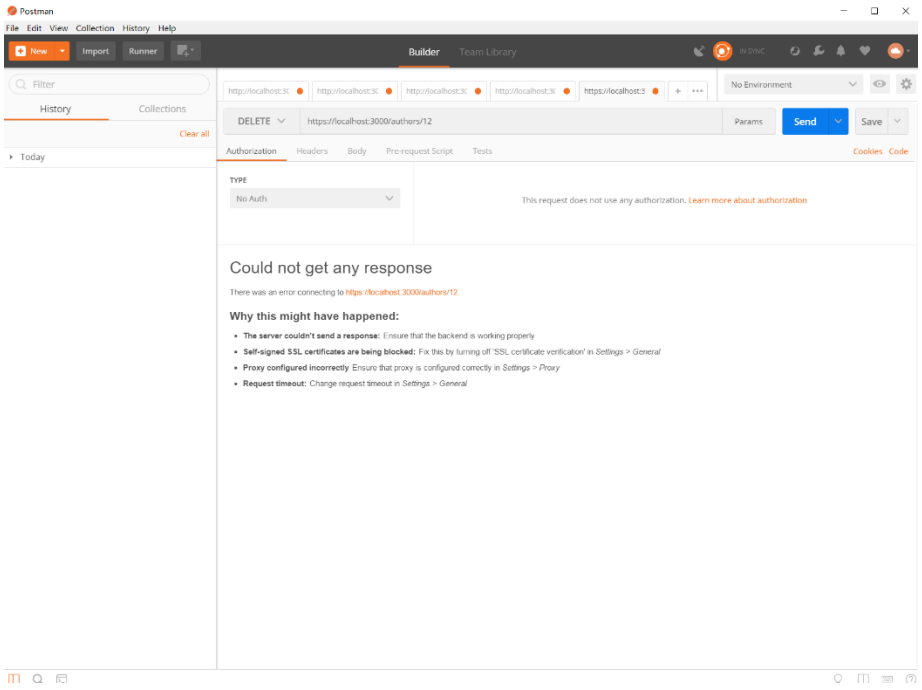
After comparing the js code with the documentation, it is found that the actual request URL should be http://localhost:3000/api/authors/14.

Manually changing the requested https to http. After submitting the request parameters in json format, the API will return a 200 status code,

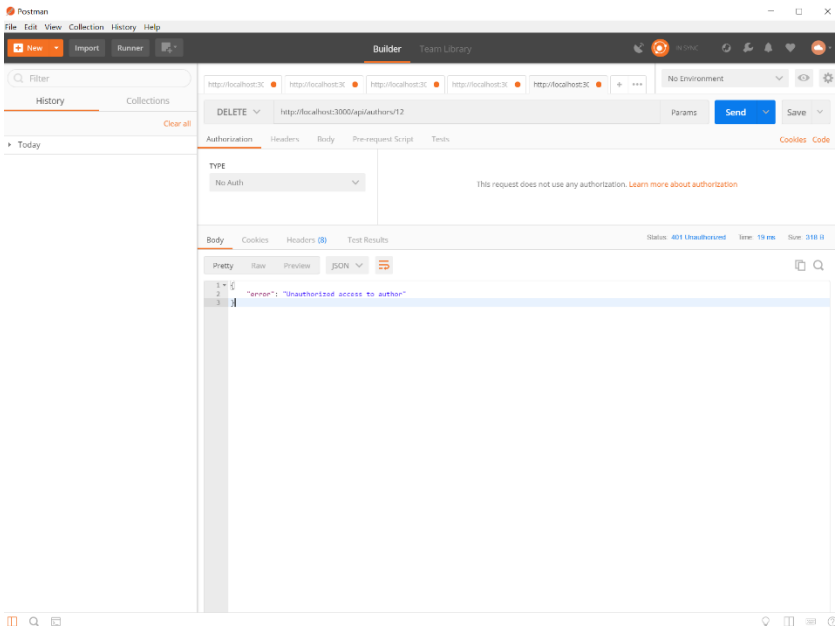
Error message: Author updated, after testing, only photo information with id greater than 13 can be updated.

This part of the content is not explained in the documentation.

5. removing a specific item (Delete)

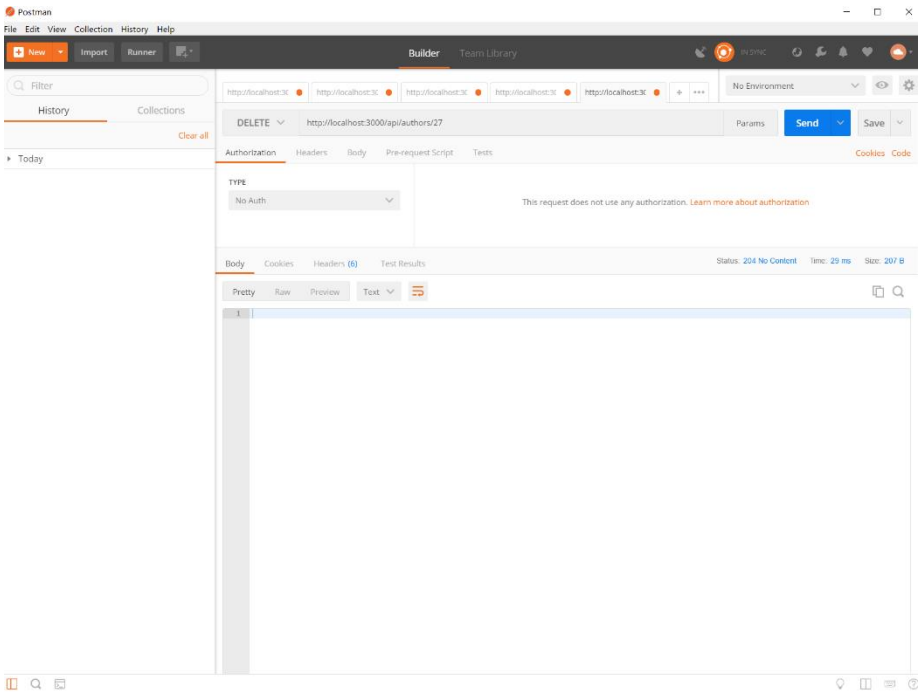


According to the steps suggested in the documentation, using the DELETE method to request https://localhost:3000/authors/12, Postman prompts: Could not get any response, no status and data are returned.



After comparing the js code with the documentation, it is found that the actual request URL should be http://localhost:3000/api/authors/12, using http request instead of https request, manually changing the requested https to http, and the API will return 401 status code after submitting the data, error message: Unauthorized access to author. The photo information with id 12 cannot be deleted.

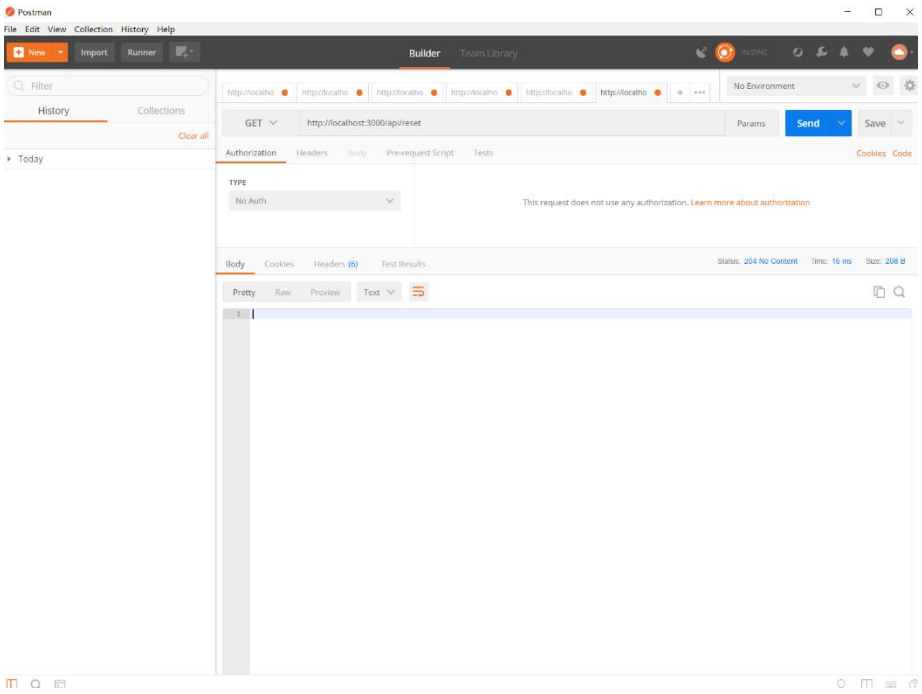
After comparing the js code, it is found that deleting photos with id>0 and id<12 will return this information.



Setting the id to 27, re-request, and finding that the 204 status code is returned. By querying all photo information, you can see that the information with photo id 27 has been successfully deleted.

This part of the content is not written in the documentation, only by querying the js source code can we find out the correct way to use the DELETE request.

Bonus part



In the bonus part, only script.js is uploaded, and the real effect is not able to be queried. By checking the codes, it is found that retrieving the full data set, add photo, reset function and other urls have been modified to their own server url, but the effect is not able to be achieved.

Using Postman to test the provided reset method, calling http://localhost:3000/api/reset through GET request, returning a 204 status code, and all photo information in the database are reset to the initial 13 records, proving The reset API executes successfully.

Actionable feedback

The assignment has been done well, although the update and put operations are mismatched.

1. The function of retrieve the full data set is fully achieved. The status can be used correctly and the corresponding data can be returned. The function is consistent with the documentation.

2. The function of to add data for a new photo item (Create) is fully achieved. When the request parameters do not meet the specifications, it is able to correctly verify and return the correct status code and data. When the add is successful, using the correct 201 status code, the function is consistent with the documentation.

3. The functions of to list the data of a specific item (Retrieve) are fully achieved, and the 200 status can be used to return the data with the specified id in the database. If the id does not exist, the 404 status code will be used to return the prompt information. The function is consistent with the documentation.

4. Changing data of a specific item (Update) is implemented under certain restrictions, adding the restriction that the data with id from 1 to 13 cannot be modified, and this part of the restriction is not explained in the documentation. Besides, the URL provided by the documentation https is used incorrectly, and the request parameters are not in standard json format.

5. Removing data of a specific item (Delete) is implemented under certain restrictions, adding the restriction that data with id from 1 to 13 cannot be deleted, and this part of the restriction is not explained in the documentation.

The Bonus part cannot be tested because only script.js is uploaded, but the reset function provided by the API can be successfully called using Postman and returns a 204 status code, which is consistent with the description in the documentation.

What we learnt

By reviewing their assignment, we gained deeper view of the concept of REST and the implementation of CRUD, which gave us a higher level of understanding of web development. In terms of codes, they use appropriate functions and clear comments. Besides, from their mistake which is mismatching of documentation and actual return, we learnt the importance of checking and paying more attention to details. Furthermore, their documentation has different layout with ours, which shows the other possibility of documentation to us.